

DOS AND DON'TS OF NET ETIQUETTE

DO: Start slow and communicate initially only through emails

DON'T: Reveal name, address, phone number, workplace or other information

DO: Set up a separate email account for communicating

DON'T: Use your regular or official email id with a person you don't know well

DO: Look for odd behaviour; serious people respect space and time

DON'T: Use signature lines in your emails that include phone number and address

DO: Show emails to a friend; unbiased observers often spot warning signs

DON'T: Don't get prematurely close to someone, even if online

DO: Chat on the phone; best way to recognise communication and social skills

DON'T: Meet unless you are ready to meet; collect information first

DO: Use prepaid mobiles or block off phone number from appearing on caller IDs

DON'T: Ignore lies, inconsistent information, different appearance than their online image

DO: Even if you plan to meet, remember you can always change your mind

DON'T: Ignore if they never introduce you to friends, associates or family members

DO: Meet in a safe, public place (not a movie hall) where lots of people are around

DON'T: Arrange for your prospective match to pick you up or drop you at home

DO: Be wary of those who ask for money. Cut off communication.

DON'T: Ignore displays of anger, dominating or disrespectful behaviour



45% Men and women don't believe in matching horoscopes

makes serious money from a big-ticket KPO company. Yet, they feel uncomfortable with her wishlist: She wants someone who's also working in Bangalore ("I don't want to quit my job for a man"); she wants someone who's more or less her age ("I should be able to relate to him"); she is looking for someone whose salary outshines hers ("I don't want my husband to get an inferiority complex"); she wants someone whose parents live in the same city as hers ("I don't want to split my vacations by shuttling between two cities"). She systematically says "no" to men who don't appeal to her. She doesn't care about caste and horoscope-matches or the fact that she's 28.

As romance rides the information highway, compatibility is now the code word. Forget sun signs, log on to personality profiling. Sycorian requires clients to answer a swathe of questions to gauge their personality traits and then picks potential partners. The Delhi-based matrimonial bureau has created a unique software programme which sifts through applications and finds a suitable match. "We match people up via compatibility rather than just using a picture and a paragraph," says counsellor, Rekha Vaid, adding: "Everyone has a unique personality profile. So ultimately a successful match is a match of attitudes." Using the enhanced learning of psychology

and behavioural sciences, their software programme sifts through details like ideal height-weight, eating and drinking habits to find the most suitable match. And in a new-liberalised India, there are enough people willing and able to shell out Rs 11,000 to Rs 1,50,000 for such a service.

"Modern marriages are facing modern challenges," observes psychoanalyst, Ashis Nandy. Women's movement, changes in the cultural psychology of sexuality and economic shifts that make double-income families more viable have irrevocably transformed the underpinnings of arranged marriages, he feels. The younger generation has clearly

62% Mumbai and Pune men do not care about fair skin, **36%** in Delhi do